

Lama guanicoe

Guanaco



Length 3–7 ft
(0.9–2.1 m)

Tail 9½–10½ in
(24–27 cm)

Weight 210–290 lb
(96–130 kg)

Location W. to S. South
America

Social unit Group

Status Least concern



The guanaco prefers cold habitats, mainly grasslands, but also scrub and forest, at heights up to 14,500 ft (4,500 m). It browses and grazes on many grasses and shrubs, as well



LLAMA



Domestic llamas are descended from wild guanacos domesticated 4,000–5,500 years ago. They have been raised by Andean peoples for their wool (fiber), meat, and skins, and have also been used as pack animals.

as lichens and fungi. Typical family groups consist of one male and 4–7 females with young. In the north of its range, the offspring leave their group at about one year of age, compared to closer to 2 years in more southerly populations. Young males form bachelor bands; old males are mostly solitary in their lifestyle.

COLORATION
A typical guanaco is pale to dark brown, with whitish chest, belly, and inner legs, and gray to black head with white-edged eyes, lips, and ears.

Vicugna vicugna

Vicuña



Length 4–6¼ ft
(1.2–1.9 m)

Tail 6–10 in
(15–25 cm)

Weight 84–100 lb
(38–45 kg)

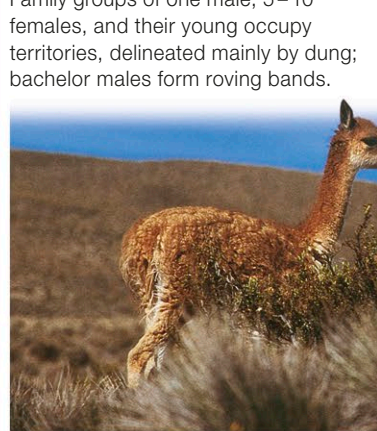
Location W. South
America

Social unit Group

Status Least concern



Found in tundralike grasslands at 10,500–16,000 ft (3,200–4,800 m) above sea level, the vicuña is a strict and selective grazer, grasping perennial grasses with its prehensile, cleft upper lip and snipping off the tips against the tough upper pad. It needs to drink daily. Family groups of one male, 5–10 females, and their young occupy territories, delineated mainly by dung; bachelor males form roving bands.



ALPACA



Alpacas, bred mainly for their thick fiber, were once thought to be domesticated from the guanaco, in the high Andes of central Peru, 5,500–6,500 years ago. New evidence now suggests a vicuña ancestry.

WHITE BIB
The vicuña is pale to dark cinnamon, with a variable whitish chest “bib.”

Camelus ferus

Wild bactrian camel



Length 10¼–11¼ ft
(3.2–3.5 m)

Tail 20–25 in
(51–64 cm)

Weight 990–1,100 lb
(450–500 kg)

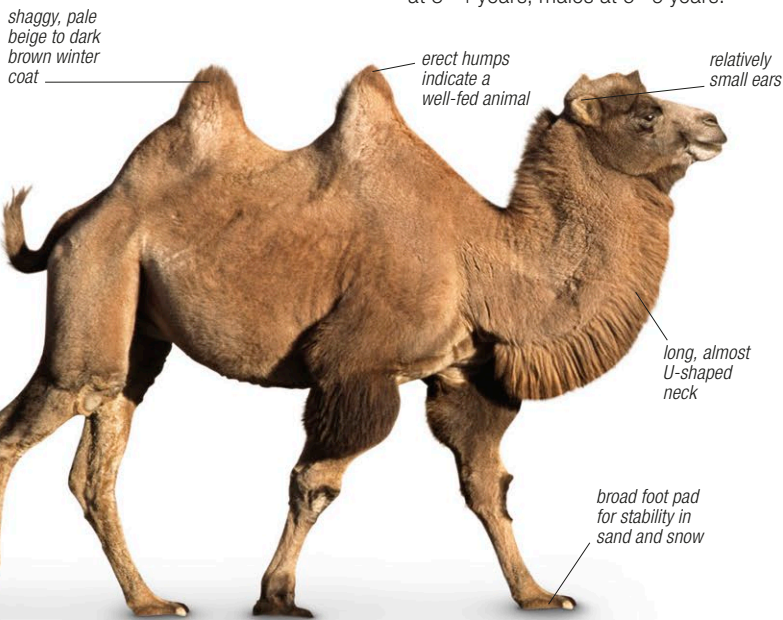
Location E. Asia

Social unit Group

Status Critically endangered



Critically endangered in the wild (a domesticated animal is shown), this 2-humped camel can withstand temperatures from –20° F (–29° C) to 100° F (38° C). After a drought, it can drink 24 gallons (110 liters) of water in 10 minutes. It eats grasses, leaves, and shrubs. During the rut, males puff out their cheeks, toss their heads back, and grind their teeth. The winner gains 6–30 females and offspring. One young (rarely twins) is born after 390–430 days’ gestation and is suckled for 18 months. Females attain sexual maturity at 3–4 years; males at 5–6 years.



Camelus dromedarius

Dromedary



Length 7¼–11 ft
(2.2–3.4 m)

Tail 20 in
(50 cm)

Weight 880–1,320 lb
(400–600 kg)

Location N. and E. Africa,
W. and S. Asia

Social unit Group

Status Not evaluated



Extinct in the wild, this one-humped domestic camel shows many adaptations to desert life, losing up to 40 percent of its body weight when food and water are scarce. Allowing its temperature to rise in hot conditions, it reduces sweating to conserve moisture. It feeds on a huge variety of plants, including salty and thorny species, and also scavenges on bones and dried-out carcasses. Dromedaries form small herds of several females and young, and one male, who defends them by spitting, biting, and leaning on opponents.

